

## **To the Graduate Admissions Committee,**

I'm writing this letter because I strongly support Mohammad's application to your graduate program. I met Mohammad for the first time at the OurCSDFW 2024 Workshop, which was hosted by the University of Texas – Arlington. Immediately, I recognized Mohammad's ability to adapt and lead in a challenging technical environment that was new to him and also recognized his great intellectual curiosity. After this initial meeting, Mohammad worked on a research project with me during the summer and then continued working on this project for the fall semester, balancing this commitment with a very challenging academic workload.

What impressed me about Mohammad was not just his ability to complete assigned tasks, but also how he approached the learning process itself. The project we worked on together was completely new to him – yet instead of hesitating due to the uncertainty of working with a completely novel topic, he embraced the opportunity with excitement and anticipation. He worked hard to comprehend as much as he could about the unfamiliar subject matter, making thoughtful inquiries, persevering, and thus enhancing his level of confidence as a result of having worked in an area of knowledge that he had previously not been exposed to. This level of effort and persistence that he demonstrated demonstrate an openness and willingness to venture outside of his normal area of knowledge/ experience while simultaneously persevering through the complexities inherent to operating in this space, clearly demonstrate that he is prepared and capable of undertaking the rigors associated with graduate-level study.

At the same time during this period, while Mohammad was conducting his research project with Dr. Debashri Roy, he also maintained the same level of energy, consistency, and discipline with respect to that research as well. It is difficult to balance multiple research responsibilities in addition to coursework; however, even at such a young age, Mohammad was able to do this with both professionalism and maturity. His ability to keep focused on various projects, and to provide value in different research environments shows excellent skills in managing time effectively, as well as a sincere desire to contribute to the body of knowledge and conduct scholarly research.

At this stage of his undergraduate education, Mohammad has experienced the process of publishing research already has a first author of a peer-reviewed paper. Instead of becoming complacent due to early accomplishments, he has sought out other opportunities and challenges that promote his continued growth and development. In addition to the fact that he has begun to experience success in his previous area of research, the fact that he chose to work with me on a different project in the area of research is evidence of his desire to broaden his knowledge base and learn more about new topics, as well as to continue working on new challenges to develop as a thinker.

In addition to being productive in the area of research, he consistently demonstrates a number of strong personal characteristics that will enhance his ability to be successful when pursuing a graduate degree. These include effective communication skills, thoughtful reflection on feedback, and the ability to maintain resilience in the face of uncertainty and obstacles. Mohammad often took the lead in conversations, assisted other students with clarifying their thoughts, and helped create an environment that is conducive to cooperative and supportive research efforts for others. These factors, along with his innate drive, indicate that he will continue to be highly productive in graduate school, where he will need to take responsibility for his learning while also maintaining a high level of commitment to his own academic success.

In conclusion, Mohammad demonstrates a strong desire and interest in his education; he has the discipline of an accomplished graduate researcher and is committed to developing

new skills. Mohammad is capable of effectively balancing coursework while performing multiple research tasks and continuing to learn. His involvement in academics will serve him well and I am confident he will be successful in graduate school. Additionally, he will add value to your institution's academic and research communities. I strongly recommend Mohammad for admission into your program. Please contact me for further information.

**Sincerely,**  
**Dr. Xiaojun Shang**  
*(Title & Affiliation)*

University of Texas at Arlington